

US–Iran Conflict Briefing

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US and Iranian officials talk with mediators separately; Trump confirms contact

- US and Iranian officials spoke separately with mediators on Monday as part of a renewed push to end the seven-month war, according to officials of both countries; further talks are expected to focus on an amended version of Iran's seven-day proposal. — [Reuters](#)
- President Trump confirmed at the White House that US officials spoke with mediators on Monday, gave no details, and said he expects the war to end "one way or the other" and "pretty quickly." — [Reuters](#)
- Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said in a CBS Face the Nation interview that Tehran is ready for talks on its nuclear program and other issues but would not accept "bullying or coercion," adding that it had already agreed "we're not supposed to develop nuclear weapons." — [Reuters](#)
- Trump wrote on Truth Social on Monday, "I offered them NOTHING!" — denying reports that he was willing to ease sanctions and release frozen Iranian funds for "concrete progress" on the nuclear issue. — [Reuters](#)
- Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi said Sunday that "only a negotiated solution can get them out of this deadlock" and that any move toward reopening the Strait of Hormuz is contingent on Iran's conditions being met. — [Reuters](#)

RAF Fairford suspects released on bail; Rubio points to a "foreign actor"

- All five British nationals arrested near RAF Fairford on September 27 were released on strict police bail on Monday; UK counter-terrorism police say the investigation continues and all five remain subject to stringent conditions on their movements. — [CNN](#)
- UK counter-terrorism police are examining multiple lines of inquiry, including the possibility that individuals were acting knowingly or unknowingly on behalf of a foreign state; authorities have not publicly established that a foreign state was responsible. — [CNN](#)
- Secretary of State Marco Rubio told Fox News on Monday night that the suspected plot "clearly involves the hands of a foreign actor," adding that "a lot more news" was to come. — [CNN](#)
- President Trump said he "wouldn't have done that" regarding the bail release, and when asked whether the case might be linked to Iran said, "It might be... I'd rather not" elaborate; Iran's London embassy denied any involvement as "unfounded and malicious." — [CNN](#)

Hormuz exports rebound as Iran's chokehold loosens, analysts report

- UKMTO reported no confirmed attacks or disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz during the preceding 72 hours — the last listed attack was September 23 — despite Iranian media claims of continued assaults. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Iranian crude held afloat outside the blockade has fallen to about 15 million barrels from 29 million in early September, and Kpler expects it to deplete by early-to-mid October. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

- Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said of Iran's oil exports: "Probably within the next two weeks... they are going to make their final deliveries of oil to China, and then they will have nothing." — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Saudi Arabia resumed oil loading at Yanbu after the East-West pipeline restart, with pipeline throughput around 2.65 million barrels a day and a full return to 5.5 million possibly a month away. — [Reuters](#)

Markets

- Brent crude stood at \$97.36 a barrel on September 29, with prices rising for a second session on continued Middle East supply concern. — [Reuters](#)
- WTI crude was around \$92.15 a barrel on September 29 as prices rose for a second session on Middle East supply concern. — [Reuters](#)
- The US average diesel price stood at \$6.529 a gallon for the week ending September 21 (EIA), the latest weekly reading ahead of the September 28 release; the White House is weighing emergency measures including red-dyed diesel tax relief amid the spike. — [Reuters](#)
- The VLCC day rate for Middle East–China hit a record \$1.27 million on September 21, LSEG data showed, as Saudi crude sales for ship-to-ship transfer off Oman boosted tanker demand. — [Reuters](#)

Shipping

- About 9 million barrels a day of crude and products flowed through the Strait of Hormuz in the seven days through September 22, Kpler data showed — roughly 60 percent of the 2025 average, up from a late-July low of 2.2 million. — [Reuters](#)

Related media

■ [Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian tells CBS Face the Nation that Tehran is open to talks but rejects "bullying or coercion."](#)